



CFLI/FCIL

Canada Fund for Local Initiatives
Fonds canadien d'initiatives locales

CFLI Malaysia Information Session

Wednesday 18th March 2026

Canada 



AGENDA

1. Introduction to CFLI
2. Application Process:
 - Thematic priorities
 - Approval process
 - Considerations
3. Budget
4. Deadline for proposals
5. Further questions



INTRODUCTION TO CFLI



The Canada Fund for Local Initiatives (CFLI) is a program designed to fund **small-scale bilateral projects that align with Canada's foreign policy priorities**

Managed by Canadian Embassies & High Commissions in countries eligible for Official Development Assistance (including Malaysia)

CFLI allows Canada to support the important project-based work of local civil society organizations

INTRODUCTION TO CFLI

In Malaysia, the CFLI has funded over 30 projects totaling more than \$1M CDN since 2013/2014

In 2025/26:

- \$245K CDN
- 192 applications received
- 10 projects funded

Past projects have focused on:

- women's rights and empowerment
- supporting the rights of LGBTQI+ and Orang Asli, refugees and other vulnerable communities
- combating corruption
- strengthening political participation
- protecting the environment

CFLI PRIORITIES



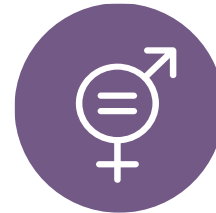
Growth that works for everyone



Environment and climate change



Democratic governance and
Human Rights



Gender equality and the
empowerment of women and girls



Peace and security

ELIGIBLE ORGANIZATIONS

- Local non-governmental, community and not-for-profit organizations,
- Local academic institutions working on local projects,
- International non-governmental organizations working on local development activities,
- Intergovernmental, multilateral and regional institutions, organizations and agencies working on local development activities,
- Municipal, regional or national government institutions or agencies of the recipient country working on local projects, and
- Canadian non-governmental and not-for-profit organizations that are working on local development activities.

APPLICATION PROCESS

1. Short application form email to our email address cflimalaysia@outlook.com, by 13th of April 2026 at midnight.
2. Evaluation and shortlist by CFLI Coordinator*
3. Shortlisted candidates are contacted for a more detailed proposal and budget*
4. Final evaluation and selection from shortlisted detailed proposals by CFLI Committee*
5. Successful applicants contacted; work together to develop Project Approval Document, Project approval by the Political Counselor *
6. Contribution Agreement (legal agreement) signed by High Commissioner*



APPLICATION CONSIDERATIONS

- Length of project funding: usually 7-8 months (activities from July 2026 to Feb 28, 2027)
 - 2-year project proposals may be considered (July 2026-Feb 2028) but most CFLI projects are 1-year
- Project size: variable; based on need. Average CAD 10-30K but larger projects possible
- Geographic & thematic portfolio mix
- Impact & sustainability of results
- Target audience – who will project benefit?
 - gender-based analysis (GBA+)



APPLICATION CONSIDERATIONS



- CFLI funding can be complementary / support part of a larger project (*but we are most interested in results of the CFLI-funded portion/activities*)
- Projects can receive other sources of donor funding
- Not intended for marketing or publicity purposes
- Not intended to provide humanitarian services or materials
- No construction

BUDGET



- Contributions will be made in **CAD**, then **converted to RM**
- **Costs must be specifically associated** with the CFLI project activities. No “core funding” – project funding
- Only expenses **post-effective date** allowed
- **Provide an estimate of a realistic budget** – do not inflate!
- On average fund between 10-30K CAD per project per year.
- Be as accurate as possible; **you will have to report on your budget later**

APPLICATION DEADLINE

Applications must be submitted via email to our email address cflimalaysia@outlook.com by **April 13th, 2026 at 23:59 (GMT+8)**

Only complete proposals in the designated short form format will be accepted. Do not send supplemental documents; only the application form will be considered

Only shortlisted applicants will be contacted for a detailed proposal and budget (target: by end-April 2026)



QR CODE APPLICATION SHORT FORM



<https://bit.ly/4d47X3f>

**QUESTIONS
& ANSWERS**

THANK YOU